

YOUR TIN

YOUR POWER

Take control of your groupage imports



Uganda Revenue Authority
DEVELOPING UGANDA TOGETHER

1. Are you importing goods through groupage (shared containers)?
2. Do you have a Tax Identification Number (TIN)?
3. Did you know your TIN allows you to declare and pay taxes for your imported goods?

HERE IS WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- 1 Obtain a Tax Identification Number (TIN) for customs declaration and clearance.
- 2 Work only with registered cargo consolidators.
- 3 Know your shipper/consolidator – understand who is sending your goods.
- 4 Know your cargo – be fully aware of all goods packed on your behalf.
- 5 Ensure proper documentation – including invoices, receipts, and any other relevant records.
- 6 Request a copy of the customs entry number used to clear your goods.
- 7 Obtain a packing list to avoid fraud or misrepresentation.
- 8 Know your tax roles – be aware of how much tax is due to URA.
- 9 Be present and participate during the verification of your goods at customs.

BENEFITS OF CLEARING CUSTOMS TAXES THROUGH YOUR OWN TIN

1. Faster processing and clearance of your goods.
2. Enables you to claim Withholding Tax (WHT) and Value Added Tax (VAT) refunds.
3. Enables you build a direct relationship with URA.
4. Access to pre-importation guidance and other taxpayer support services.
5. Full visibility and control over the clearance process.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE TIPS

Do NOT share your TIN or password. This prevents unauthorised individuals from clearing goods in your name.

Need Help? Visit the Manager Warehousing at the URA Headquarters, NIP Building for further guidance.

For more details



Toll Free Line:
0800-117000, 0800-217000



Visit our website
www.ura.go.ug



Send an email
services@ura.go.ug

Follow us



WhatsApp

0772140000

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE TO CLEARING GOODS USING YOUR TIN

Step 1- Shipment of Goods

- The shipping line issues a master bill to the consolidator.
- The consolidator splits the bill into individual House bills (separate bills).
- The Importer obtains an individual House bill from the consolidator.

Step 2-Port Clearance (Mombasa or Dar es Salaam)

- The consolidator appoints a licensed custom clearing agent to submit a customs declaration (WT8) to URA.
- Once approved by URA, the goods are released from the port for direct transit to a customs Bonded Warehouse in Uganda.

Step 3-Arrival and Verification in Uganda

- The consolidated shipment is jointly received by the warehouse keeper and URA customs.
- Each importer appoints a clearing agent to handle their specific goods using their individual House bills (Separate bills).
- URA conducts a joint physical verification of the entire shipment in the presence of the importers or agents to confirm that all goods are properly declared.

Step 4-Transfer of Ownership and House Bill Issuance

- The consolidator applies on URA ASYCUDA system for the transfer of each importer's goods to their TIN, attaching the corresponding House bill of lading.
- URA approves and updates its records to reflect the rightful owner.

Step 5-Tax Payment by Importers

- The importer's appointed agent submits a home use declaration (IM4) and pays the correct taxes for the goods.
- URA verifies and confirms the payment.

Step 6-Release of Goods

- URA physically releases the goods to the importer once the process is complete.

YOUR GOODS, OUR PRIORITY!

Disclaimer

This information is strictly for creating awareness and providing guidance to our clients. It should not at any one time be used in place of substantive law; and is subject to change on amendment of tax legislation and any other regulations governing tax administration.